How a Unicorn Called Buddy Became a Surprise Movie Hit

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In 2026, a movie called Buddy became a surprise hit. It is a **horror comedy** by Casper Kelly about a 1990s TV show **mascot** with a dark side. According to the people who made it, what made Buddy stand out was not just the jokes or the scares. It was the feeling underneath.

Buddy the Unicorn is funny and charming, but he also has a darker side and feels sorry for what he does. That mix helped build a very unusual **marketing campaign**. Roadside Attractions showed people the character first, before revealing his darker side. The campaign made many people wonder if Buddy was a **cancelled** TV show they had forgotten about. By then, they already cared about the character.

At a filmmaking **summit** in Los Angeles, producer Tracy Rosenblum, co-writer Jamie King, and marketing head Melissa Yerou talked about the years of work behind the overnight success. King said he knew Kelly would make it really funny, and his friends at BoulderLight would make it really scary, so he tried to add heart.

Word Treasure

mascot -- A character made to represent a show or team.

horror comedy -- A movie that mixes scary parts with funny parts.

marketing campaign -- A planned way of sharing something with the public to get people interested.

cancelled -- Stopped and not continued.

summit -- A meeting where people talk about a subject.

Background you need

A horror comedy is a movie that mixes funny moments with scary ones.

A mascot is a fun character made to represent a show, and people can grow to care about a character before they know the whole story.

A marketing campaign is how a movie team shares a character and story with the public to get people interested.

Break it down

WHO: Buddy the Unicorn, Casper Kelly, and the people who made the film, including Tracy Rosenblum, Jamie King, and Melissa Yerou.

WHAT: Buddy became a surprise hit, helped by a marketing campaign that showed the character first and built curiosity about him.

WHERE: In Los Angeles, where the makers talked about the film at a filmmaking summit.

WHY: Because people already cared about Buddy before learning his darker side, and the film mixed jokes, scares, and heart.

Why it matters

It can help you notice how a character or story can win your interest before you know the whole story.

Test what you remember

1. What kind of movie is Buddy?

- (A) A marketing campaign
- (B) A filmmaking summit
- (C) A horror comedy
- (D) A 1990s TV show

2. According to the people who made it, what made Buddy stand out?

- (A) Just the jokes
- (B) Only the darker side
- (C) The feeling underneath
- (D) Just the scares

3. How did the marketing campaign introduce Buddy?

- (A) It showed people the character first, before revealing his darker side
- (B) It hid the character from everyone
- (C) It showed only his darker side
- (D) It revealed his darker side first

4. What did the campaign make many people wonder?

- (A) If Buddy was a real unicorn
- (B) If Buddy was a brand-new TV show
- (C) If Buddy was a forgotten movie
- (D) If Buddy was a cancelled TV show they had forgotten about

5. Who said he tried to add heart?

- (A) Melissa Yerou
- (B) Casper Kelly
- (C) Tracy Rosenblum
- (D) Jamie King

6. According to King, who would make Buddy really scary?

- (A) His friends at BoulderLight
- (B) Melissa Yerou
- (C) Casper Kelly
- (D) Tracy Rosenblum

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: A 4: D 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. The people who made Buddy: They said what made Buddy stand out was the feeling underneath, not just the jokes or the scares.

2. Jamie King: He said he knew Kelly would make it really funny and his friends at BoulderLight would make it really scary, so he tried to add heart.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):